

festival

Fun Unlimited

DELHI It's festival time and there is a sumptuous spread of art, dance, poetry, music and theatre in the offing. Prasiddha Foundation has organised the Delhi International Arts Festival presented by The Forum for Art Beyond Borders from December 7 to 23. "It's an annual event which aims at creating world-class cultural equity for the city, projecting it as the world's future culture capital," says Pratibha Prahlad, director of the festival.

It opens with the first-ever exhibition of Pichhawa's of *Shrinathji: In Adoration of Krishna* at the National Museum.

Pichhawa's are devotional paintings that are hung behind the image of Krishna at Shrinathji. The festival showcases different genres in music. On December 21, Sufi music comes alive as the Wadali brothers—Puranchand and Pyarelal—their sufiana kalam an aural treat, be it their rendering of *Bullehshah*, *Baba Farid*, *Shah Hussain* or *Kabir*. They are followed by Warsi Brothers from

Hyderabad and Parvathy Baul from Kolkata. We rarely have western choirs performing in the city—the Capital City Minstrels choir conducted by Gabriella Roda Rechner will render sacred music of the season, including hymns in various languages on December 18.

For classical music buffs there are performances of Shanti Sharma (vocal), Shujat Hussain Khan (sitar), Kadri Gopalnath (saxophone), Sudha Raghuraman (Carnatic vocal), Kumaresh and Jayanti Kumaresh (violin-veena duet) from December 21 to 23. And if you want to experience old Delhi again, along with mouth-watering cuisine and ghazals by Penaz Masani, Bhupinder-Mitali and Talat Aziz, head towards Chandni Chowk. For the youth the festival features, from December 15 to 20, fusion bands, creative dance and percussion ensembles.

The festival also features short films. There will be a special section of video dance taken from the Video Dance Festival of India, Danzlenz, and films on Indian artistes and their art presented by Jatin Das Centre for the Arts.

by S. Sahaya Ranjit

SONG AND DANCE: Odissi dancer Ranjana Gauhar (bottom left) and classical singer Meeta Pandit



art exhibition

Bare Facts

MUMBAI If Jatin Das's own intensity is anything to go by, then his latest works in oils and water colours, drawings and graphics promise to be intense and definitely something to watch out for. It took him six years to create them. Das is exhibiting in Mumbai after a hiatus of 11 years. "I find it very boring to exhibit any more. It takes immense energy to organise and the people don't want to see the paintings," he says. His work is a unique visual journey through his preoccupation with sculpted human forms and the bare figure. Das's definitive strokes add magic to his forms, both sensuous and spiritual. "Painting isn't a job, it is my own motivation to create more art. People at large should know that the making of an artist takes sadhana—a continuous struggle," he explains. Preferring to exhibit at Jehangir Art Gallery, Das's show is presented by Gallery Art and Soul. On display starting December 10 to 18.

by Swati Mathur

In Prayer by Jatin Das



art

Bright Past

DELHI The paintings were a riot of colours and a maelstrom of visuals. The images were vibrant, kitschy and the subjects equally engrossing—*Lal Pari* and *Draupadi*, the full-size painting depicted woman power. *Landslide* depicted nature's wrath, while *Contemplation* had a swan sitting on wild grass.



Rainbow Tara by Sterre

Sterre Sharma's exhibition in the Capital last week was inspired by mysticism and Indian mythology. "I didn't force a unifying theme. It is just from the heart," says Sharma.